

Kyra Hoffman

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EDUCATION

Vassar College | Poughkeepsie, NY
Bachelor of Arts in Environmental Studies
GPA 3.79 / 4.00; Departmental Honors

May 2024

Thesis: A Dam Solution: Understanding the potential of beavers in stream restoration in Casperkill watershed
Dr. Deon Knights

HONORS & AWARDS

Sigma Xi Honor, Vassar College Chapter

2024

The Collins Student Research Fund, Envir. Research Institute, Vassar College

2023

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Jill Troy Werner Sustainability Education Fellow, Vassar College
Office of Sustainability

Jul. 2024 – Present

- Supervising multiple teams of students through data collection and analysis projects
- Coordinating lab exercises as the teaching assistant for environmental science courses
- Played a key role in pushing Vassar College's decarbonization plan forward and in developing their five-year climate action plan
- Updated and maintained Vassar's sustainability data platforms including developing a project database and a sustainability map

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Asst., Earth Science Department, Vassar College
Dr. Deon Knights

Jun. – Aug. 2024

- Compiled and interpreted large amounts of data
- Created a model of nutrient removal using GIS and Microsoft Excel in an urban stream
- Drafted and working to publish a research paper

Research Asst., Envir. Research Institute, Vassar College
Dr. Deon Knights

Jun. – Aug. 2023

- Conducted multi-hour benthic chamber and solute tracing experiments in the field, collecting water samples
- Ran water samples through an ion chromatograph and correcting the resulting curves
- Completed an eight-page literature review of beaver wetland hydrology
- Working compiling conclusions in a poster presentation

Research Asst., Undergraduate Research Summer Institute, Vassar College
Dr. April Beisaw

May – Jul. 2022

- Trained on and proficient in the use of GIS, ArcGIS, and GPS in Field Work
- Collected and compiled large amounts of data to support research
- Developed final report communicating research and key stories

Research Asst., Earth Science Department, Vassar College

Jan. – May 2022

Dr. Kirsten Menking

- Collected water samples at multiple points of the year
- Completed spectrophotometry on a series of lake water samples, examining nutrient levels.
- Finished a report on findings of nutrient pollution and made recommendations about further steps for remediation

RESEARCH SKILLS

Field Work: Water sampling, Benthic chamber experiments, Dilution gauging and solute tracing, GPS marking and tracing, Archaeological unit digging/shovel test pits, Surveying, Well slug and bail testing, Aquifer characterization

Wet Laboratory: Light/Polarizing microscopy, Spectrophotometry, Ion Chromatography, X-Ray Diffraction

PRESENTATIONS

American Geophysical Union Conference, New Orleans, LA

Dec. 2025

Poster: "The Effects of Beaver Ponds on Nitrate Uptake in an Urban Stream"

Envir. Research and Praxis Symposium, Vassar College

Feb. 2024

Poster: "The effects of seasonality and nutrient loading on nutrient uptake in an urban beaver wetland"

American Geophysical Union Conference, San Francisco, CA

Dec. 2023

Poster: "The effects of seasonality and nutrient loading on nutrient uptake in an urban beaver wetland"

New York State Archaeological Conference, Orange, NY

Apr. 2023

Poster: "Champagne and Shadows: Mapping the Costs of City Water"

Poster: "Research Using the New York Poorhouse Spatial Database"

MEMBERSHIPS

American Geophysical Union

Jun. 2023 – Present

Geological Society of America

Jun. 2023 – May 2025

Sigma Xi

May 2024 – May 2025

SKILLS

Certifications:

R Certified

Platforms:

Google Workspace (Advanced) , Office 365 (Advanced), ArcGIS (Pro, Online, Storymaps, Fieldmaps), QGIS, Adobe Creative Cloud (Photoshop, Illustrator), Canva, Procreate